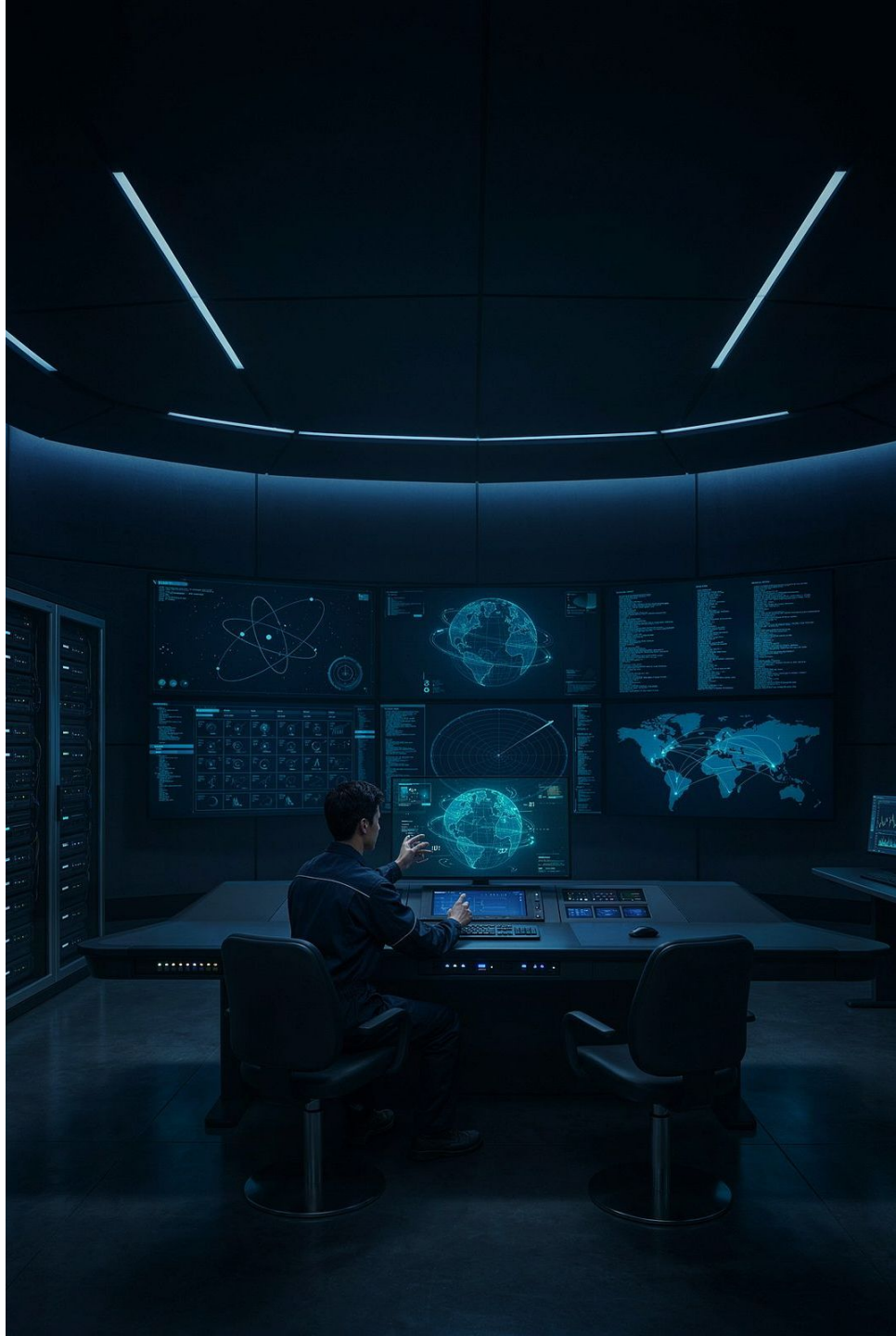
From Costs to Agents: The AI Operations Revolution

Three transformative forces — AI FinOps, AI-Augmented Ops, and AgenticOps — are reshaping how modern organizations operate. Each builds on the last, forming a natural journey from **controlling AI spend** to **empowering AI to act autonomously**.

A PRACTICAL GUIDE





Setting the Stage

Why AI Operations Needs a New Playbook

Organizations are deploying AI faster than ever — but many are discovering a painful truth: **AI without governance is expensive, unpredictable, and hard to scale.** Cloud bills spike without warning. Teams operate in silos. Automation stalls because no one owns the workflow end-to-end. This presentation maps out a logical path — from getting AI costs under control, to augmenting your teams, to finally letting AI agents run entire processes on their own.

CHAPTER 1

AI FinOps: Getting Control of What You're Spending

The Problem

A retail company rolls out an AI recommendation engine. Three months later, the cloud bill has doubled. No one can explain exactly why — model inference costs, API calls, and storage fees are scattered across a dozen teams with zero visibility.

What AI FinOps Solves

AI FinOps brings **financial accountability** to AI workloads. It applies the principles of cloud FinOps — cost visibility, allocation, and optimization — specifically to AI infrastructure: model training runs, inference endpoints, GPU clusters, and third-party API usage.

- Tag and track costs per model, team, and use case
- Set budgets and alerts on inference spend
- Rightsize GPU and compute resources
- Measure cost-per-prediction or cost-per-output

AI FinOps in Practice

Real organizations are already seeing measurable impact from disciplined AI cost management.

40%

Cost Reduction

Average savings reported by enterprises after implementing AI FinOps practices within 6 months

3x

Faster Decisions

Speed improvement in budget approval cycles when AI spend is tagged and attributed to business outcomes

$2M+

Avg. Waste Found

Idle GPU instances and over-provisioned endpoints discovered in first AI FinOps audit at mid-size firms

Think of AI FinOps like an electricity meter for your AI — you can't optimize what you can't measure.

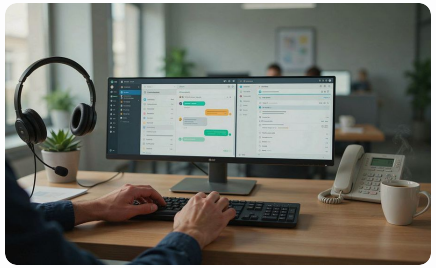


CHAPTER 2

AI-Augmented Ops: Making Your Team Smarter

Once you have AI spend under control, the next step is putting AI to work **alongside your people**. AI-Augmented Ops means embedding AI tools directly into day-to-day workflows — not to replace humans, but to make every person on the team faster, sharper, and more effective.

What AI Augmentation Looks Like on the Ground



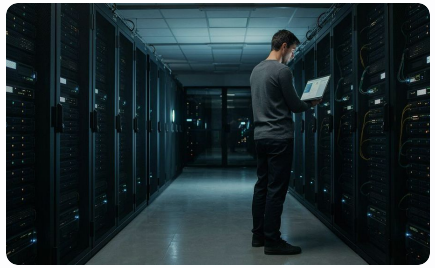
Customer Support

AI reads incoming tickets, suggests responses, and flags urgency — agents resolve issues **60% faster** without losing the human touch.



Finance & Reporting

AI drafts variance reports, flags anomalies in spend data, and auto-generates monthly summaries — analysts focus on decisions, not data wrangling.

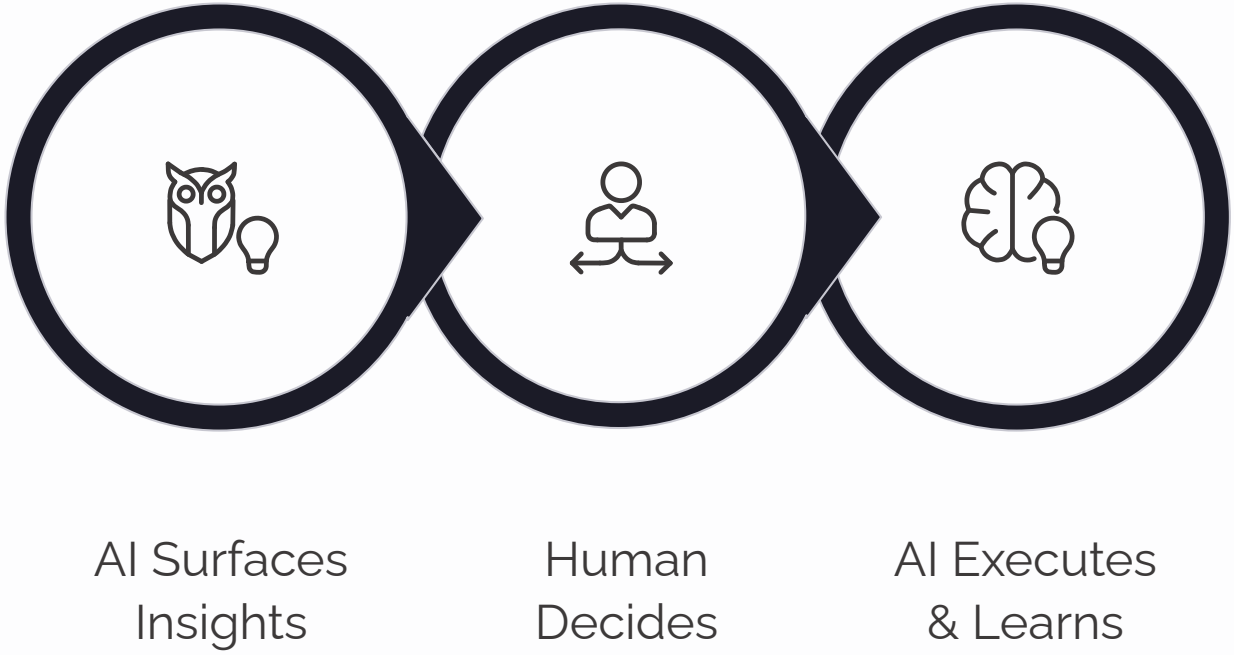


IT Operations

AI monitors system health 24/7, predicts failures before they happen, and recommends remediation steps — IT teams shift from reactive to proactive.

The Human + AI Partnership

AI-Augmented Ops is not about automation for automation's sake. It's about **augmenting human judgment** with machine speed and pattern recognition.



The key insight: humans remain in the loop for judgment-heavy decisions, while AI handles the volume, the pattern matching, and the grunt work. This builds trust in AI systems before organizations take the next step — full autonomy.



CHAPTER 3

AgenticOps: When AI Takes the Wheel

AgenticOps is the frontier. **AI agents** are software systems that don't just respond to prompts — they set goals, make decisions, use tools, and execute multi-step tasks **without waiting for a human to press go.** This is the natural evolution: once you trust AI to assist, you can begin to trust it to act.

AgenticOps: Real-World Scenarios

AI agents are already running end-to-end processes in forward-thinking organizations.

🛒 E-Commerce Replenishment

An AI agent monitors inventory levels, predicts stockouts using sales trends, places purchase orders with suppliers, and updates the ERP — all without a buyer touching it. A human reviews exceptions only.

🔒 Cybersecurity Response

When a threat is detected, an AI agent isolates the affected endpoint, opens a security ticket, gathers forensic logs, and notifies the SOC team with a pre-built incident report — cutting response time from hours to minutes.

📊 Financial Close Process

An AI agent reconciles sub-ledgers, flags discrepancies, drafts journal entries for review, and sends the CFO a ready-to-approve summary — compressing a 5-day close to under 24 hours.

The Journey: From Spend Control to Autonomous Ops

These three chapters aren't separate initiatives — they form a **logical, compounding progression**. Each stage unlocks the next.



AI FinOps

Control and visibility over AI costs. Know what you're spending and why.

AI-Augmented Ops

Embed AI into workflows. Humans and AI work side by side to drive efficiency.

AgenticOps

AI agents act autonomously. End-to-end processes run with minimal human intervention.

The organizations that start with FinOps discipline today will be the ones that safely and confidently deploy autonomous agents tomorrow.